

ISO 9001:2015 Quality Management System Auditor

- Control of externally provided processes, products and services -



The organization needs to ensure that externally provided processes, products and services conform to requirements.

External providers:

- suppliers,
- subcontractors,
- associate companies,
- corporate headquarters in case of multi site organizations, etc.

Controls for products, services & processes have to be applied when:

- they are incorporated in the organization's own product & services;
- They are delivered to the customer directly on behalf of the organization;
- A process of part of it is performed by an external provider.

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The organization is required to determine and apply criteria for the evaluation, selection, monitoring of performance and re-evaluation of its external providers.
&
Documented information needs to be retained.

TYPE AND EXTENT OF CONTROL

Type and extent of controls applied to processes, products and services as well as to the external provider depend on their impact over conformity

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RISK BASED THINKING

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Examples of controls for processes provided by external providers:

- ensure that the personnel of the external provider has the needed qualifications;
- inspection performed at the site of the external provider by the organization or by a third party contracted by the organization;
- testing of products provided in a laboratory.

Examples of verifications for processes, products and services:

- inspection of products received,
- review of conformity documentation (certificates, test reports);
- second party audits – audits performed by the organization at its suppliers;
- testing – on samples of products or on all products;
- review of statistical data or performance indicators.

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INFORMATION FOR EXTERNAL PROVIDERS

The organization has to ensure that it communicates clearly to external providers the requirements and the controls needed for the processes, products and services it intends to purchase.

Requirements communicated to external providers:

- requirements for the processes, products and services;
- competence required including qualifications of personnel;
- interactions of the external provider with the organization;
- controls applied to the external provider by the organization to monitor its performance;
- verification or validation activities.

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AUDITING

- The policy of the organization for evaluating, selecting, monitoring and re-evaluating suppliers, the criteria used for this process and the documented information that sustain this processes.
- The use of the risk based approach.
- The systems used by the organization to communicate their requirements to external providers.
- The system used by the organization to verify that its requirements for the processes, products and services have been fulfilled.

Review of documented information (*list of suppliers, supplier evaluation, orders, conformity documents, testing reports, communication with suppliers, etc*)

Interviews.